

Vidich's firm, Manalapan Oracle Capital Management, is located in a small town in central New Jersey. Vidich is an amateur artist, and Manalapan's offices can double as an art gallery, as his paintings adorn every wall. His style ranges between postimpressionism and abstract, with some paintings having one foot in each camp. Vidich says he is not technically proficient—and indeed his paintings that include animal figures have a primitive style—but he has a strong sense of color. There are clear influences of Gauguin and Van Gogh in his work. (Interested readers can view a selection of his paintings at www.easthurley.com.) Vidich says that he began painting many years ago as a way to relax. The more stress in his life, the more he paints. He was particularly prolific the year he divorced.

Vidich seems to enjoy whatever he is doing, whether it is trading or being interviewed. He has a loud, booming laugh, which was triggered often in our interview, as he was clearly amused by his recollections.



[Vidich opened our conversation by asking why I had selected him for an interview.]

Why you? That's relatively easy. In terms of return/risk, in the 10 years you have been running this fund, you have generated better numbers than 99 percent of the managers out there, and that is exactly what I'm looking for. How did you first get involved in stocks?

I got into the stock market because my brother's friend who was a stockbroker was going to India to see his guru and needed someone to sit at his desk for a month to simply answer the phone. I had just graduated college and wasn't doing anything yet, so I said I would do it.

What did you do when there was a phone call from a client who wanted to place an order?

I gave it to the guy next to me. I wasn't registered, so I couldn't do anything. I eventually did get registered as a stockbroker with the same firm.

What degree did you graduate with?

I had a master's of international business from the Columbia School of International Affairs. Almost all the people I graduated with went to work